

CSE 4102: Computer Graphics and Image Processing Laboratory

**SENTINEL: A FULLY PROCEDURAL GAME ENGINE  
AND OPEN-WORLD MILITARY SHOOTER**

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October 8, 2026**

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Department: Computer Science and Engineering

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## **Acknowledgment**

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I also thank the open-source communities behind the Odin programming language, GLFW and miniaudio, and the authors of the papers and teaching notes listed in the references: this project stands on their published work. Finally, I thank my family and friends for their support and for patiently playtesting the game.

**Author**

## Abstract

Most video games ship with gigabytes of files made by artists: 3D models, photographs for surfaces, recorded sounds. *Sentinel* takes the opposite route. It is a complete game engine and an open-world military shooter in which *nothing* is loaded from a model, image or sound file. Every tree, building, soldier, vehicle, surface texture, cloud and sound effect is created while the program starts, from short mathematical recipes and a random seed. Only the small text files that hold the shader programs are read from disk.

The engine is written in the Odin language on OpenGL 4.1 (the newest version macOS offers, which has no compute shaders), and is organised in six layers, each allowed to depend only on the layers beneath it. A deferred renderer draws the scene in two steps: first it records what every pixel is made of, then it lights it with a sun and moon, spot and point lamps, cascaded shadow maps, screen-space ambient occlusion and reflections, an atmospheric sky with wind-driven clouds, fog, bloom, tone mapping, colour grading and anti-aliasing. Surfaces come from 18 texture recipes built on periodic gradient noise, domain warping and cellular noise; normal maps are derived from height fields with a Scharr filter. Objects and characters are tables of primitives with noise deformers. On top sit collision, a ladder state machine, four ground vehicles, a helicopter, enemy soldiers with stealth rules, synthesised audio and a five-objective rescue mission in the spirit of *Project I.G.I.*

The project was measured and verified, not just drawn. At 1080p the renderer needs about 10.9 ms of GPU time per frame; 281 unit tests, 30 GL checks, 8 318 texture checks (including exact tiling of every material), 318 567 renderer checks and two scripted full playthroughs pass. The report explains each technique in plain language, supports it with the governing equations, and documents a debugging case in which a star in the fog colour painted a bright vertical line across the night scene.

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# CHAPTER I

## Introduction

### 1.1 Introduction

Imagine a film studio where nothing is bought: not one prop, painting or costume. Instead, a recipe book tells assistants how to build every tree, wall and cloud while the audience waits, and the same recipe with a different “seed” number gives a different but equally believable forest. *Sentinel* is that studio for a video game. It is a *game engine* (the reusable machinery that draws, simulates and sounds a game world) together with a *game* built on it: a first-person military mission in an open landscape. The word *procedural* means “made by a procedure”: geometry, colours and sounds are calculated by code instead of being stored.

#### In plain words

A **GPU** is a second processor with thousands of tiny cores, built to colour millions of pixels at once. A **shader** is the small program every core runs for its pixel. A **texture** is a “wallpaper” stretched over a surface. Here, even the wallpapers are painted by shaders at start-up.

### 1.2 Background and Problem Statement

Computer graphics teaches the pieces separately: transformations, lighting models, texture mapping, noise and image filtering. Real products need them to work *together* at 60 frames per second. Normally the visible content is made in external art tools and loaded as large files, which hides how surfaces and shapes can come from mathematics. The problem addressed here is: *can a complete, good-looking, playable 3D game be produced by code alone, within the limits of a student laptop?* Two limits make this hard. First, rules of the project: no model, image or precomputed data file is allowed. Second, the platform: macOS supports OpenGL up to version 4.1, which has no compute shaders and no shader storage buffers, so every filter and bake must be written as an ordinary full-screen pass.

### 1.3 Objectives

1. Build a layered engine (platform, GPU, procedural content, world, renderer) with strict downward-only dependencies.
2. Generate all meshes, textures and sounds at run time from code and seeds.
3. Implement a modern real-time renderer: physically based shading, shadows, atmosphere, post-processing.
4. Build a playable game on it: movement, weapons, enemies, vehicles, a helicopter, ladders, doors and a mission.
5. Prove it works: unit tests, GL checks, scripted playthroughs and frame-time measurements within a 60 fps budget.

### 1.4 Scope

Table 1.1 lists the tools. The scope covers the whole engine and one game; it does not cover networking, multiplayer, hand-made art or console targets.

Table 1.1: Tools and technologies used

| Tool                                             | Role (plain words)                                                                  |
|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Odin language                                    | The programming language of the whole project; fast like C, readable like a script. |
| OpenGL 4.1 core                                  | The standard way to talk to the graphics card on macOS.                             |
| GLSL shaders                                     | Programs run by the GPU for every vertex and pixel (47 files, about 2 000 lines).   |
| GLFW                                             | Opens the window, reads keyboard and mouse.                                         |
| miniaudio                                        | Sends calculated sound samples to the speakers; all sounds are synthesised.         |
| Git/GitHub, L <sup>A</sup> T <sub>E</sub> X/TikZ | Version history (138 commits) and this report.                                      |

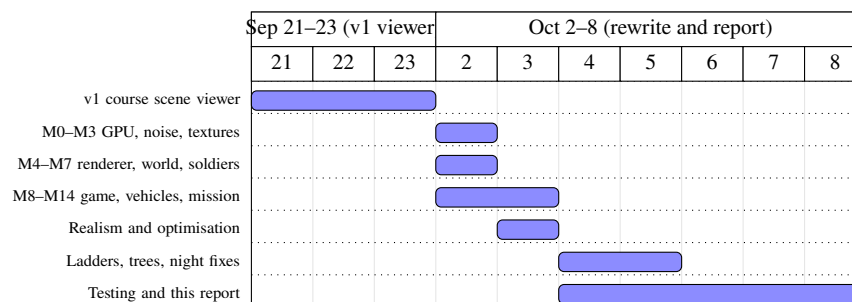


Figure 1.1: Work plan (days). The single author performed all tasks.

## 1.5 Unfamiliarity of the Problem and its Solution

The design follows published theory but is not copied from a code base. Engines usually import art; demo-scene programs such as *kkrieger* prove that tiny procedural shooters are possible but target a single platform and are not teaching material. Here the constraint “no files” is a *design rule enforced on every feature*, and the engine is written to be read: every file has one feature, every procedure is short, and Docs/Features.md maps each feature to its file. An earlier course version (git tag legacy-v1) was a scene viewer; this report describes the complete rewrite.

## 1.6 Project Planning and Work Distribution

The work was done by one student, who therefore held every role: designer, programmer, tester, and writer. Figure 1.1 shows the schedule reconstructed from the commit history (138 commits).

## 1.7 Applications of the Work

The engine teaches graphics and procedural generation and is a base for small games shipped as source code only.

## 1.8 Organization of the Project

Chapter II surveys related work. Chapter III explains the design and every major technique. Chapter IV reports measurements and screenshots. Chapters V and VI discuss social, ethical and engineering-complexity issues, and Chapter VII concludes.

Table 2.1: Comparison with related approaches (typical characteristics)

| Feature                    | Tutorial demos | Commercial engines | .kkrieger | Sentinel |
|----------------------------|----------------|--------------------|-----------|----------|
| No imported art            | Mixed          | No                 | Yes       | Yes      |
| Complete game loop         | No             | Yes                | Yes       | Yes      |
| Day/night, clouds, shadows | Rare           | Yes                | No        | Yes      |
| Needs compute shaders      | Varies         | Often              | No        | No       |
| Written to be read         | Yes            | No                 | No        | Yes      |

## CHAPTER II

### Related Works

#### 2.1 Introduction

Sentinel combines four research lines: procedural noise, physically based shading, real-time pipeline tricks and whole procedural games.

#### 2.2 Related Works

**Noise.** Perlin’s improved noise [1] gives smooth random hills by blending random gradients on a grid; summing several scales (fractal Brownian motion) gives natural detail. Worley’s cellular noise [2] measures distance to random points and yields pebbles, leaves and cracks. Quilez’s domain warping [13] bends the sampling position by another noise to break grid-like patterns. Sentinel uses all three, made *periodic* so textures tile without seams.

**Shading.** The Cook–Torrance microfacet model [3] with the GGX distribution [4] is the standard physically based reflection model; Karis [5] showed a practical real-time form. Oren–Nayar [8] models rough matte surfaces such as cloth.

**Pipeline.** Deferred shading [14] separates “what is visible” from “how it is lit”. Cascaded shadow maps [7] give sharp nearby and coarse far shadows. Hillaire’s sky model [6] computes sunsets from scattering physics; ACES tone mapping [9], FXAA [11] and dithered output [10] finish the picture.

**Whole games.** *.kkrieger* (2004) squeezed a shooter into 96 KB by generating content at run time. *Project I.G.I.* (2000) inspired the mission design here: infiltrate a compound, hack, destroy, rescue, extract.

#### 2.3 Discussion

Table 2.1 shows the gap. Existing teaching demos (such as step-by-step OpenGL tutorials) cover one technique each; commercial engines assume imported art; demo-scene shooters are not platform-independent teaching code. Sentinel adds a readable, layered, fully procedural engine with a complete game on macOS-limited OpenGL.

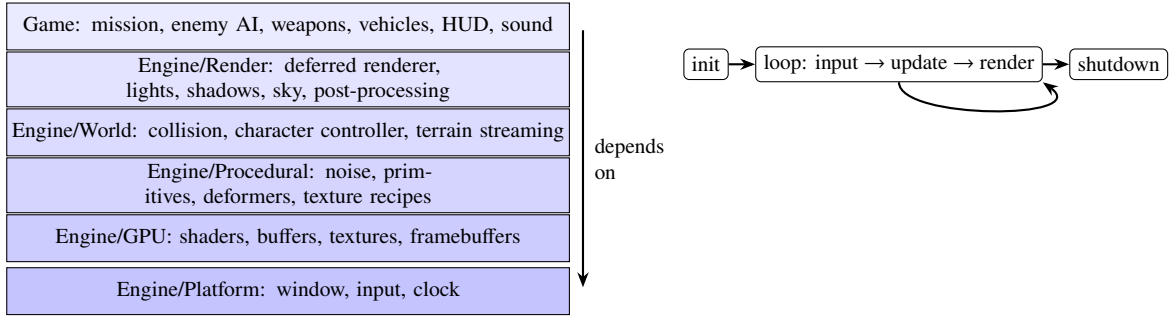


Figure 3.1: The six layers (dependencies point downward) and the main loop.

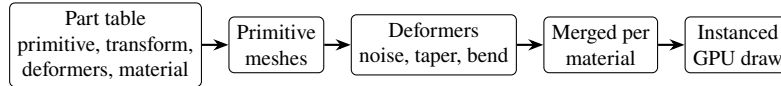


Figure 3.2: From a data table to pixels: content is data, not code.

## CHAPTER III

### Methodology

#### 3.1 Introduction

Making one frame is an assembly line: the game decides what exists, the engine builds its shapes and surfaces, the renderer paints it, and the result appears 60 times per second. This chapter follows that line.

#### 3.2 Detailed Methodology

##### 3.2.1 Problem Design and Analysis and Overall Framework

Figure 3.1 shows the six layers and the main loop. A lower layer never knows about a higher one, so the renderer can be tested without any game. Source/Main.odin is only a table of contents: initialise, then repeat *input*, *update*, *render*, then shut down. Other rules keep the code readable: procedures at most about 40 lines, full-word names with units last (*range\_meters*), assertions on preconditions, and every OpenGL call checked for errors.

##### 3.2.2 Procedural Geometry and Characters

Every object is a *table* of parts, each a primitive (box, sphere, cylinder, cone, capsule, torus, wedge), a transform, optional deformers and a material (Fig. 3.2). A noise deformer pushes each vertex along its normal  $\hat{n}$  by a smooth random amount, so a perfect sphere becomes a lumpy rock; with noise  $v \in [-1, 1]$  no vertex moves farther than the amplitude  $A$ :

$$\mathbf{p}' = \mathbf{p} + A v(f \mathbf{p}) \hat{n}, \quad \|\mathbf{p}' - \mathbf{p}\| \leq A. \quad (3.1)$$

Taper, bend, twist and bulge are similar one-line deformers. Soldiers are a skeleton of capsules and boxes; a walk is a sine wave of phase, and a leg reaches its foot target by *two-bone inverse kinematics*: for bone lengths  $a, b$  and root–target distance  $c$ , the knee angle follows from the law of cosines,

$$\cos \theta_{\text{knee}} = \frac{a^2 + b^2 - c^2}{2ab}. \quad (3.2)$$

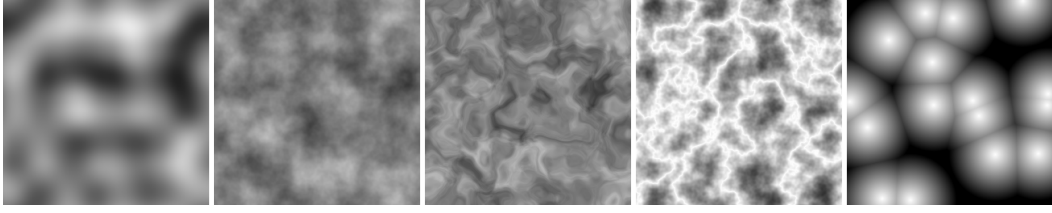


Figure 3.3: Noise ingredients (a re-implementation of the shader equations, for illustration): gradient, fractal, domain-warped, ridged, cellular.

### 3.2.3 Procedural Textures

Each material is a *recipe*: a small shader that answers “what is the colour, bumpiness, shininess and crevice-darkness at this point?” The engine runs each recipe once at start-up into a 1024×1024 picture (22 materials from 18 recipes, Table 3.1) and keeps it on the GPU.

#### In plain words

*Gradient noise* is like a rubber sheet pinned at grid points, each pinned at a random slope: smooth, never repeating exactly. *Fractal noise* adds finer and finer sheets on top, like hills, boulders and pebbles together.

Gradient noise blends the four corner gradients  $\mathbf{g}_c$  of the grid cell with the smooth curve  $s(t) = 6t^5 - 15t^4 + 10t^3$ , scaled by  $\sqrt{2}$  so that values lie in  $[-1, 1]$ . Fractal noise sums octaves, each at double frequency and half strength:

$$F(\mathbf{x}) = \frac{\sum_{i=0}^{n-1} 2^{-i} v(2^i \mathbf{x})}{\sum_{i=0}^{n-1} 2^{-i}}. \quad (3.3)$$

Because corner gradients are chosen from the cell index *modulo the period*  $P$ ,  $F(\mathbf{x} + P\mathbf{e}) = F(\mathbf{x})$ : the picture tiles with no seam (checked exactly by the test suite, Section 4.4). Variations give different materials: *domain warping*  $F(\mathbf{x} + s[F_1(\mathbf{x}), F_2(\mathbf{x})])$  swirls the pattern (stone, wood, soil); *ridged noise*  $\sum a_i(1 - |v_i|)^2$  makes cracks and bark; *cellular noise* gives leaves and pebbles (Fig. 3.3).

**Bumps without geometry.** A recipe also outputs a height map; the engine turns it into a *normal map*, which fools the lighting into seeing bumps. The height slope uses the Scharr  $3 \times 3$  filter, the most direction-fair small filter:

$$\frac{\partial h}{\partial x} \approx \frac{3(h_{NE} + h_{SE} - h_{NW} - h_{SW}) + 10(h_E - h_W)}{32 \Delta}, \quad \hat{n} = \frac{(-k h_x, -k h_y, 1)}{\|\cdot\|}. \quad (3.4)$$

Where the height is below its neighbours’ average (a crevice), albedo and ambient occlusion are darkened. On objects the picture is applied by *triplanar mapping*: it is projected along the three axes and blended by  $w_i = |n_i|^k / \sum_j |n_j|^k$ , so deformed shapes never stretch the texture.

### 3.2.4 The Rendering Pipeline

#### In plain words

*Deferred shading* is like photographing a “data poster” of the scene first (every pixel’s colour, direction and shininess), then lighting the poster once instead of lighting every object separately. It makes many lights cheap.

The poster is the *G-buffer* (Table 3.2). Figure 3.4 lists the passes. Direct light uses the

Table 3.1: Material families (22 materials, 18 recipe shaders)

| Family                                     | Recipe idea                                                           |
|--------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Concrete, rock, sand, dirt, asphalt        | Warped fractal tone, pores/pebbles from cellular noise, ridged cracks |
| Painted, rusted, gun metal; olive paint    | Panel seams, scratches, sun fade, rust patches with pits and streaks  |
| Wood, bark, birch bark                     | Stretched ridged noise (fissures), sine rings under fibres            |
| Leaves, needles, grass                     | One cell per leaf/needle/blade tip, tone from the cell's random roll  |
| Canvas, camo, fabrics, rubber, skin, glass | Woven threads, ripstop grid, grooves, pores, smooth glass             |

Table 3.2: The G-buffer (one “data poster” per frame)

| Layer                      | Format       | Contents                                                |
|----------------------------|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Albedo + model id          | sRGB 8-bit   | Surface colour; which illumination model                |
| Normal + roughness + metal | 16-bit float | Direction packed in two numbers (octahedral), shininess |
| Emission + occlusion       | 16-bit float | Light the surface gives off; crevice darkness           |
| Depth                      | 32-bit float | Distance; world position is rebuilt from it             |

Cook–Torrance model [3]: a diffuse part plus a mirror-like specular part,

$$f_s = \frac{D F G}{4(\mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{l})(\mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{v})}, \quad D = \frac{\alpha^2}{\pi((\mathbf{n} \cdot \mathbf{h})^2(\alpha^2 - 1) + 1)^2}, \quad F = F_0 + (1 - F_0)(1 - \mathbf{v} \cdot \mathbf{h})^5, \quad (3.5)$$

where  $D$  says how many tiny mirror facets face the viewer (GGX),  $G$  how much they shadow each other,  $F$  how much light reflects at a glancing angle (Schlick), and  $\alpha$  is the surface roughness squared. Six illumination models are selectable per pixel (Lambert, Phong, Blinn–Phong, Oren–Nayar, Cook–Torrance, subsurface). Distant things fade into haze: with distance  $d$  and density  $k = 3.5 \times 10^{-4} \text{ m}^{-1}$ ,

$$C = T C_{\text{surface}} + (1 - T) C_{\text{haze}}, \quad T = e^{-kd}. \quad (3.6)$$

Finally the HDR image is compressed to screen range with the ACES curve [9] (Narkowicz fit), graded, dithered [10] and smoothed (FXAA [11]):

$$C_{\text{out}} = \text{clamp}\left(\frac{x(2.51x + 0.03)}{x(2.43x + 0.59) + 0.14}\right), \quad x = \text{exposure} \times \text{radiance}. \quad (3.7)$$

### 3.2.5 Sky, Time of Day and Clouds

The sun’s direction comes from astronomy: with latitude  $\varphi$ , declination  $\delta$  and hour angle  $h = 15^\circ(\text{hours} - 12)$ , its height is

$$\sin(\text{elevation}) = \sin \varphi \sin \delta + \cos \varphi \cos \delta \cos h. \quad (3.8)$$

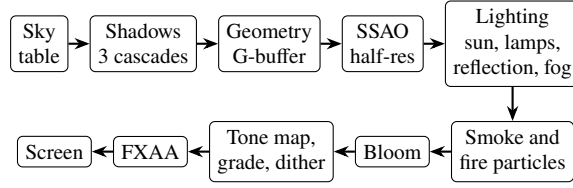


Figure 3.4: One frame, left to right then back along the lower row.



(a) Before: bright vertical line



(b) After: fixed

Figure 3.5: A debugging case. The fog colour sampled the *whole* sky, stars included, along a horizontal direction, so one star at the horizon painted a vertical streak on every surface in that column (left of centre). The fog now uses the smooth atmosphere only.

The colour of the sky is precomputed each frame into a small table from Rayleigh and Mie scattering (blue sky, red sunset) [6]; the moon and a hashed star field take over at night. Clouds live on two imaginary planes, cumulus at  $H = 1500$  m and thin cirrus at 7 km. A view ray with direction  $\mathbf{d}$  meets the plane at

$$\mathbf{P}_{xz} = \frac{H}{d_y} (d_x, d_z) + \mathbf{w}t, \quad (3.9)$$

where  $\mathbf{w}$  is the wind velocity: shifting the noise by  $\mathbf{w}t$  makes clouds drift, and a faster-moving detail layer lets their shapes slowly change. The cloud colour is the sky's own grey, plus a sun rim by day and a moon rim at night.

### 3.2.6 World, Physics and Gameplay

**Terrain.** Ground height is fractal noise, warped and blended with a rounded ridged term, flattened into a plateau for the base:  $h = h_0 + A v(x, z)$  smoothstep( $r_0, r_0 + w, \|\mathbf{p} - \mathbf{c}\|$ ). It is meshed in 64 m chunks that stream around the player; layers (grass, dirt, rock, sand) blend by slope and height with wandering borders.

**Trees.** Four species (oak, pine, birch, cypress) are each a few tables of limbs and leaf lumps. Every instance gets its own height, width, lean and tint, and the vertex shader bends it as a cantilever,  $\Delta_{xz} \propto (0.04 + 0.1g)(y/9)^2$ , where  $g = \frac{1}{2} + \frac{1}{2} \sin(1.3t + 0.05x + 0.03z)$  is a travelling gust, plus a small leaf flutter.

**Collision and vehicles.** Solids are boxes that may be rotated, so walls are exact at any angle; the player is a capsule. Cars use the bicycle model,  $\dot{\psi} = v \tan \delta / L$  (turn rate from speed, steering angle and wheel base  $L$ ), and engine power fades toward top speed so acceleration is strong from rest and eases off:

$$\dot{v} = a_0 \left( 1 - 0.6 \frac{|v|}{v_{\max}} \right). \quad (3.10)$$

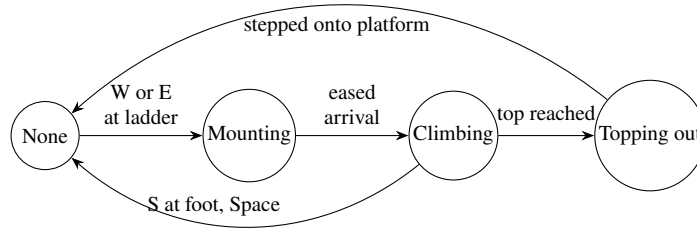


Figure 3.6: Ladder grip state machine (climb 1.1 m/s up, 1.5 m/s down, one rung every 0.3 m).

Four ground vehicles and a helicopter are boarded with E; the helicopter has a rotor spin-up and arcade flight model.

**Ladders** are a four-state machine (Fig. 3.6); while gripping, the controller, not the collision solver, owns the body, which removes getting stuck. Hands grip rungs hand over hand.

**Mission, AI and sound.** A staged objective machine drives five goals: enter the compound, hack the HQ computer, destroy the radar, rescue the hostage, reach the beacon. Soldiers patrol, see, hear (crouching is quieter), raise an alarm and call reinforcements; cameras sweep. All sounds (shots, steps, engines, alarm) are synthesised by oscillators and filtered noise shaped by envelopes and mixed in code. Progress is saved as plain text.

### 3.3 Conclusion

Each technique is small and data-driven; together they give a complete, deterministic world from seeds.

## CHAPTER IV

### Implementation, Results and Discussions

#### 4.1 Introduction

This chapter states how the work was measured and shows what it produces.

#### 4.2 Experimental Setup

The machine is an Apple-silicon Mac (macOS, OpenGL 4.1 core profile) running a release build (Odin dev-2026-09, -o:speed). The code base is 164 Odin files (about 19 200 lines) and 47 GLSL files (about 2 000 lines). Screenshots are 2560×1440; frame times come from the built-in benchmark (a scripted 1 km flight, 1920×1080, 300 frames).

#### 4.3 Evaluation Metrics

**Speed:** frame time  $t = 1000/\text{fps}$  ms (budget 16.7 ms for 60 fps) and GPU time per pass. **Correctness:** pass/fail of unit tests, GL checks and a scripted playthrough that must complete five objectives per mission. **Tiling error:**  $\max |f(\mathbf{u} + \mathbf{k}) - f(\mathbf{u})|$  for integer  $\mathbf{k}$ , which must be exactly zero for every material.

#### 4.4 Dataset

None is used. All content comes from fixed seeds, so every run is reproducible and no image, model or recording is stored.

Table 4.1: GPU time per pass, 1080p benchmark

| Pass                                      | Time (ms)    | Share       |
|-------------------------------------------|--------------|-------------|
| Geometry (G-buffer)                       | 4.11         | 38%         |
| Lighting (sun, ambient, reflections, fog) | 2.79         | 26%         |
| Shadows (3 cascades)                      | 1.58         | 14%         |
| Post-processing                           | 1.21         | 11%         |
| Ambient occlusion                         | 1.20         | 11%         |
| Sky table                                 | 0.02         | 0%          |
| <b>GPU total</b>                          | <b>10.91</b> | <b>100%</b> |

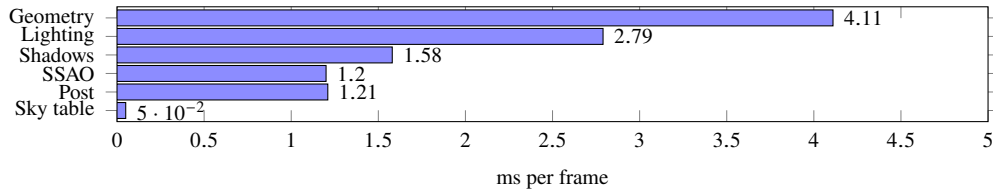


Figure 4.1: GPU time per pass (total 10.91 ms of the 16.7 ms budget).

Table 4.2: Verification summary

| Suite                    | Count   | What it checks                                                  |
|--------------------------|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Unit tests (13 packages) | 281     | Noise, meshes, IK, collision, ladders, vehicles, mission, audio |
| TextureCheck             | 8 318   | Exact tiling of all materials, normals, colour round trip       |
| RenderCheck              | 318 567 | Lighting models, shadows, atmosphere, instancing                |
| GpuCheck                 | 30      | Textures, framebuffers, shaders                                 |
| Scripted playthrough     | 2       | Both missions: 5 of 5 objectives                                |

## 4.5 Implementation and Results

### 4.5.1 Quantitative results

The average frame was 16.75 ms because the display synchronises to 60 Hz; the GPU work itself needs 10.9 ms (Table 4.1, Fig. 4.1), leaving headroom. Table 4.2 lists the verification: 281 unit tests, 30 + 8 318 + 318 567 GL checks, and both missions complete in 5 of 5 objectives.

### 4.5.2 Qualitative results

Figure 4.2 shows the running game. The showroom (Fig. 4.2c) is an automatic gallery with one sphere per material, so any new recipe is seen at once. The last row shows tree species, drifting clouds and hands on a ladder; the night scene with moonlit clouds is Fig. 3.5b.

### 4.5.3 Analysis of the results

Geometry is the largest cost because trees, base and terrain are drawn in detail, so instancing (one draw call for thousands of trees) and per-chunk culling matter most. Cheaper clouds (no warp in the sun-shading march, fewer octaves) kept the sky from growing the lighting pass. The bug in Fig. 3.5 was found by bisecting: remove draw items, lights and effects until the line disappeared, which pointed to the fog; it shows why every pass must have a test and a

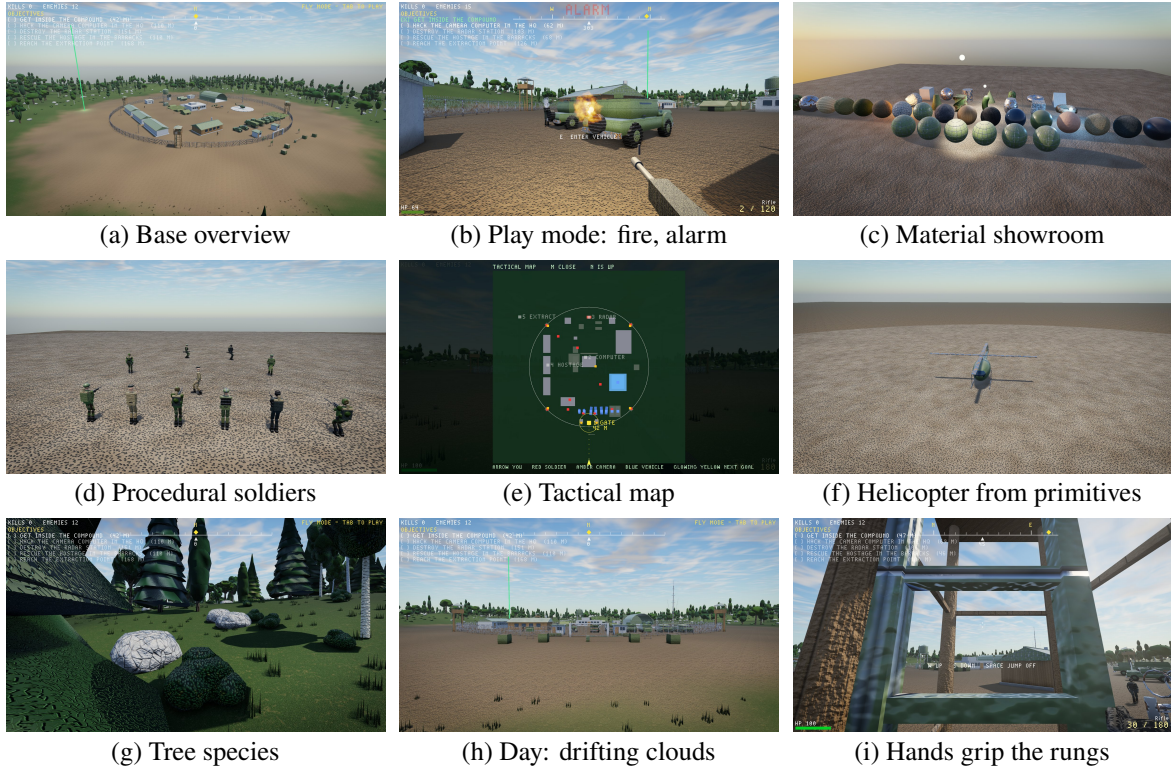


Figure 4.2: The engine and game in action (screenshots from the program), and detail results: tree species, drifting clouds, hands gripping the rungs.

Table 4.3: Objectives and how they were met

| Objective               | Result                                                                                                |
|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 Layered engine        | Six layers, dependencies downward only; <code>Main.odin</code> is a table of contents.                |
| 2 All content from code | No model, image or sound file; 22 materials, 4 tree species, 5 vehicles, soldiers, synthesised audio. |
| 3 Modern renderer       | Deferred PBR, cascaded shadows, SSAO, SSR, sky, clouds, bloom, ACES, FXAA.                            |
| 4 Playable game         | Two missions, doors, ladders, vehicles, helicopter, stealth, saves.                                   |
| 5 Verified              | 281 tests, 327 000 GL checks, 2 playthroughs, 10.9 ms GPU time.                                       |

screenshot.

## 4.6 Objective Achieved

Table 4.3 compares the five objectives of Section 1.3 with the results.

## 4.7 Conclusion

The measurements show that a fully procedural engine can meet a 60 fps budget on a laptop while passing exact correctness checks.

## CHAPTER V

### Societal, Health, Environment, Safety, Ethical, Legal and Cultural Issues

#### 5.1 Intellectual Property Considerations

All code, shapes, textures and sounds are original; there are no third-party assets to license. Libraries (Odin, GLFW, miniaudio) are open source under permissive licences. The mission is inspired by, not copied from, *Project I.G.I.*; no names, maps or art are reused.

#### 5.2 Ethical Considerations

The game is a fiction about an invented compound with abstract, low-detail figures; it contains no real places, groups or people. It is intended for adult audiences. No personal data is collected: saves are local plain-text checkpoints.

#### 5.3 Safety Considerations

Muzzle flash, alarm and explosions can bother light-sensitive players, and loud sound can hurt hearing, so brightness changes are smoothed, flashes are short and volume is mixed and limited. Playing sessions should include breaks.

#### 5.4 Legal Considerations

Open-source licence terms are respected. Violence is stylised and the project makes no claim to real military accuracy. The report credits all cited work.

#### 5.5 Impact on Societal, Health and Cultural Issues

Positive: an open, readable engine lowers the barrier to learning graphics. Negative: shooter games may encourage long play; a “peaceful” rescue and stealth emphasis (crouching, avoiding detection) is part of the design.

#### 5.6 Impact on the Environment and Sustainability

Because no art files are downloaded, the whole project is a few megabytes of source, reducing storage and transfer energy. Frame-rate limiting through display synchronisation avoids needless GPU work.

## CHAPTER VI

### Addressing Complex Engineering Problems and Activities

#### 6.1 Complex Engineering Problems

**Depth of knowledge:** radiometry, noise theory, numerical filters, GPU pipelines, collision and state machines. **Conflicting requirements:** realism versus a 16.7 ms frame, no files versus rich surfaces, OpenGL 4.1 without compute shaders. **Depth of analysis:** bisecting the fog star streak, deriving tiling guarantees, tuning physics curves. **Interdependence:** renderer, world, game and audio share data layouts and timing.

## 6.2 Complex Engineering Activities

The project used modern tools (compiler, profiler, test runners), integrated many components and verified quality by measurement.

# CHAPTER VII

## Conclusions

### 7.1 Summary

Sentinel shows that a complete 3D game, from surfaces and shapes to weather and sound, can be generated entirely by code under an OpenGL 4.1 limit. A six-layer engine, a deferred physically based renderer, noise-based material recipes, table-driven objects, a mission game with vehicles, ladders and stealth, and an extensive test suite fit in about 21 000 lines and run within a 60 fps budget.

### 7.2 Limitations

Models are blocky (primitives plus noise); there is no true global illumination or ray tracing; foliage is lumpy volumes rather than individual leaves; the beacon is a solid column; guards cannot pick up dropped weapons; and the game was tuned by scripts and screenshots rather than a large playtest.

### 7.3 Recommendations and Future Works

Add leaf cards with cut-out transparency, screen-space global illumination, point-light shadows, anisotropic highlights, networked multiplayer, and a larger user study; port to a modern graphics API with compute shaders for GPU-side generation.

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